



**Majuwa_Pangkha Non-Wood Forest Product Management
and Marketing Group**

Dophuchen Gewog

Samtse Dzongkhag



Plan Period 2023-2033

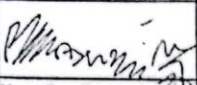
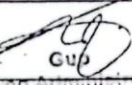
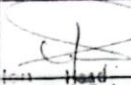
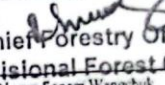
(1st Revision)

DIVISIONAL FOREST OFFICE, SAMTSE

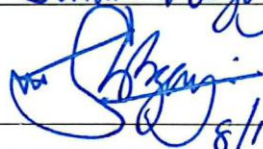


Approval Sheet

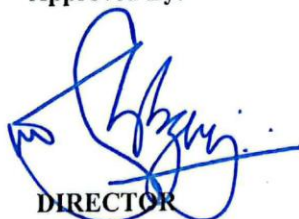
Name of the NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Majuwa_Pangkha Group
Dzongkhag	Samtse
Gewog	Dophuchen
Village	Majuwa_Pangkha
No. of households	41
Area (ha)	77
Plan period	2023-2033

Prepared and submitted for approval				
NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Forestry Representative (Facilitator)	Gewog Administration	Social Forestry Section Head	Name of Division/Park
				
Name: Dal Man Rai	Name: Dawa Tshering Lamsol	Name: Phuolsho	Name: Phuolsho	Name: Sonam Wangchuk
Title: Chairman	Title: Sr. FR	Title: Gup	Title: Head SEES	Title: CFO
Date: 30/12/2022	Date: 30/12/2022	Date: 30/12/2022	Date: 30/12/2022	Date: 30/12/2022

Reviewed and recommended for approval:

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Name	Kezang Nangmu	Sonam Tobgay
Signature		
Date	27-11-2023	8/12/23

Approved By:



DIRECTOR

Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

Acronyms

CFO	Chief Forestry Officer
CDF	Community Development Fund
DoFPS	Department of Forests and Park Services
GRF	Government Reserved Forest
GT	Gewog Tshogdu
MoENR	Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources
NWFPMG	Non-Wood Forest Product Management Group
NWFP	Non-Wood Forest Product
SFES	Social Forestry and Extension Section
PRL	Private Registered Land
RO	Range Officer

Glossary

Chiwog	Village
Dzongkhag	District
Gewog	Sub-district
Tshodgu	Decision Making Body

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Part A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan

1. Background

The Majuwa_Pangkha Non-Wood Forest Product Management and harvesting Group (NWFP) was formed by 39 households as its initial members from Sengdhen, Majuwa and Pangkha village. With the revision of the management plan, the members have increased to 41 households. The Majuwa_Pangkha NWFP management and harvesting area is located towards the Southwest of Majuwa and Pangkha village along the stretch of Samtse_Dorokha Highway starting from Deorali area to SheetiBhir near Halhalay covering an area of 77 ha (190 acres). The designated area for NWFP collection has the prominent features as its boundaries. The boundaries were demarcated as Deorali towards the north, Sheti Bhir towards the south, Lali Kharka and Rana Goan towards the west and Samtse_Dorokha Highway towards the east. It takes around 1 hour walk from the village to reach the nearest collection area and 4 hours walk to reach the farthest. However, the collection area is connected by Samtse_Dorokha road along the lower stretch of the area. The collection area is divided into three compartments depending upon its location and availability of NWFP species.

The Dophuchen Range Office has long been planning to form a NWFP Group and hand over the responsibility of sustainable management of NWFPs to the nearby Communities due to intensive illegal harvesting of NWFPs especially Cane shoot (Patsa).

The plan materialized and NWFP Management group was formed and approved in the month of September 2019 with the plan period of three years (September 2019-August 2022). However, due to Covid 19, the management group could do very little, and the plan period came to an end in the month of August 2022. Once again, the NWFP Management Group in collaboration with Range Office revised the plan in the month of December 2022 without any budgetary support.

The per-capita income is low, so the formation of the NWFP collection group would surely expect to boost their income source, livelihoods, capacity development and socio-economic development in future.

2. Goals and Objectives

- Protection of non-wood forest produce from over exploitation and illegal harvesting.
- Generation of income from sale of NWFPs.
- Sustainable harvesting of NWFPs.

3. Description on NWFPs and its sustainable harvesting prescriptions

The area identified and designated for the group shall be brought under sustainable management of forest resources and the harvesting or collection of the non-wood forest produces will be

harvested following the prescriptions and harvesting guidelines for each species. The following are the NWFP resources available in the designated area:

3.1. Patsa (*Plectocomia himalayana*)

3.1.1. Description of species

The species is a spiny, evergreen, climbing palm usually producing a cluster of stems (though sometimes solitary). It grows up to 20m long and 10cm in diameter – climbs high into the surrounding trees. The stems are unbranched for most of their length but can then branch freely to form entanglements in the tree canopy. It is a dioecious species whereby both male and female flower are found on separate individuals.

3.1.2. Basic guidelines for sustainable harvesting

a. For mature stems

- Cut cane stem only when mature, to be recognized by:
 - Loosening of leaf sheath from the lower part of the cane stem
 - Exposure of lowest part of the stem
 - Turning to yellow reddish along the entire stem length
 - Diameter over the entire length of the cane is the same (diameter at the lower part of the cane is reduced)
- Pull down as much of the stem as possible (avoid leaving cane parts high up in the tree)
- Cut only canes with a usable length of at least 10m. Discard at maximum 1.2 to 1.5 meters from the top end.
- Harvest during winter as canes have a better quality during this season (lower water content and more durable)

b. For cane shoots

- Cut young shoot by bending the cane stem with the help of a long and strong stick with a hook.
- Do not cut the entire cane to collect the shoots. Cut the leading shoot with a sharp knife diagonally (not straight to avoid rotting of the remaining stump); leave lateral shoots.
- Care shall be taken to avoid damaging sucker buds (these will later develop into lateral shoots)

c. Guidelines for both mature stems and cane shoots

- Uprooting, cutting of rhizomes/suckers shall be avoided.
- Trees supporting the cane shall not be felled.
- The debris after harvesting canes should be taken outside the cane area to avoid infection with insect borers or fungi.

3.2. Fern (*Diplazium esculentum*)

3.2.1. Description of species

The species is a large perennial fern with ascending rhizomes of about 50cm high and covered with short rufous scales of about 1mm long.

3.2.2. Basic guidelines for sustainable harvesting

- Harvest young shoot that are 15 cm length.
- Don't harvest the entire shoot coming up in season.
- Retain at least 50% of young shoot of last flush for the development of leaves.
- Don't harvest the shoots that have developed to leaves.
- Don't cut down trees which provide shade to the plants.

3.3. Damru (*Elatostema lineolatum*)

3.3.1. Description of species

The species is a medium sized herb of 30cm in height. Damru belongs to the family of stinging nettles Urticaceae, but they don't have stinging properties.

3.3.2. Basic guidelines for sustainable harvesting

- Collect plants that are 15 cm and above.
- Retain stump of around 3'' for sprouting of new shoots
- Don't uproot whole plant.
- Shouldn't disturb its catchment area.
- Shouldn't cut down the trees and create more opening.

3.4. Chirata (*Swertia chirayita*)

3.4.1. Description of the species

The species is a bi-annual plant belonging to the family Gentianaceae and dies after seed dispersal in the second year. The plant leaves and stems are reddish in colour when matured. The plant can reach up to 1.5m in height.

3.4.2. Resource assessment

The resource assessment of Chirata is conducted based on the “**Guidelines for resource assessment and management of Chirata** “*Swertia chirayita*” developed by the Department of Forests and Park Services in Jun 2008. The resource assessment should be conducted in the month of late November or early December when the plants are mature. The resource assessment and mapping are conducted by the field offices with involvement of the community members. The area identified for the collection of the species can be divided into sub-blocks

for easy assessment of production and regeneration of the species. While assessing the growing area, unproductive areas (landslide, rocks, inaccessible areas) should be excluded from the Chirata collection area.

3.4.3. Basic guidelines for sustainable harvesting

- Collect *Chirata* only after seed dispersal commenced.
- Harvest plant only after the announcement of harvesting date (It is usually announced by the coordinator/respective field forestry offices, generally in November)
- Do not collect the plants late in the season (February) because at that time there is a high risk of damaging the germination of new seedlings.

3.5. Nikima (*Tupistra nutans*)

3.5.1. Description of the species

The species is an unusual rhizomatous geophyte from the eastern Himalaya with long straps-like leaves up to a meter in length that forms a tall, lush clumps of evergreen foliage resembling a ginger.

3.5.2. Basic guidelines for sustainable harvesting

- Only flowers are collected by hand.
- Do not uproot the mother plants.
- Do not expose plant root to direct sunlight.
- Leave around 2 flowers for seed production.
- Roots planting for vegetative propagation

3.6. Details of Non-Wood Forest Produce

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area (s)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season (months)	Estimated quantity that can be harvested
Patsa	Deorali, Peepli & Sheti Bhir	Young shoot and mature stem	1. Young shoots are used as vegetables. 2. Mature stem for handicraft items	April-August October-March	250 pieces per season 2-3 back load per season
Fern	Deorali, Peepli & Sheti Bhir	Young shoot	Vegetable	July-August	500 bundles per season

<i>Chirata</i>	Peepli and Sheti Bhir	Entire Plant	Medicine	November to January	1 kg per season
Nikima (<i>Tupistra nutans</i>)	Deorali & Peepli	Flower	Vegetable	September-October	10 kg per season
Bamboo shoot (Balugopay)	Deorali, Peepli & Sheti Bhir	Stem and young shoot	Young shoot as vegetable	June-August	10 kg per season
Mushroom (Kaney chaew)	Deorali & Sheti Bhir	Whole mushroom	Vegetable	September-October	20 kg per season

4. NWFP Collection Area Map

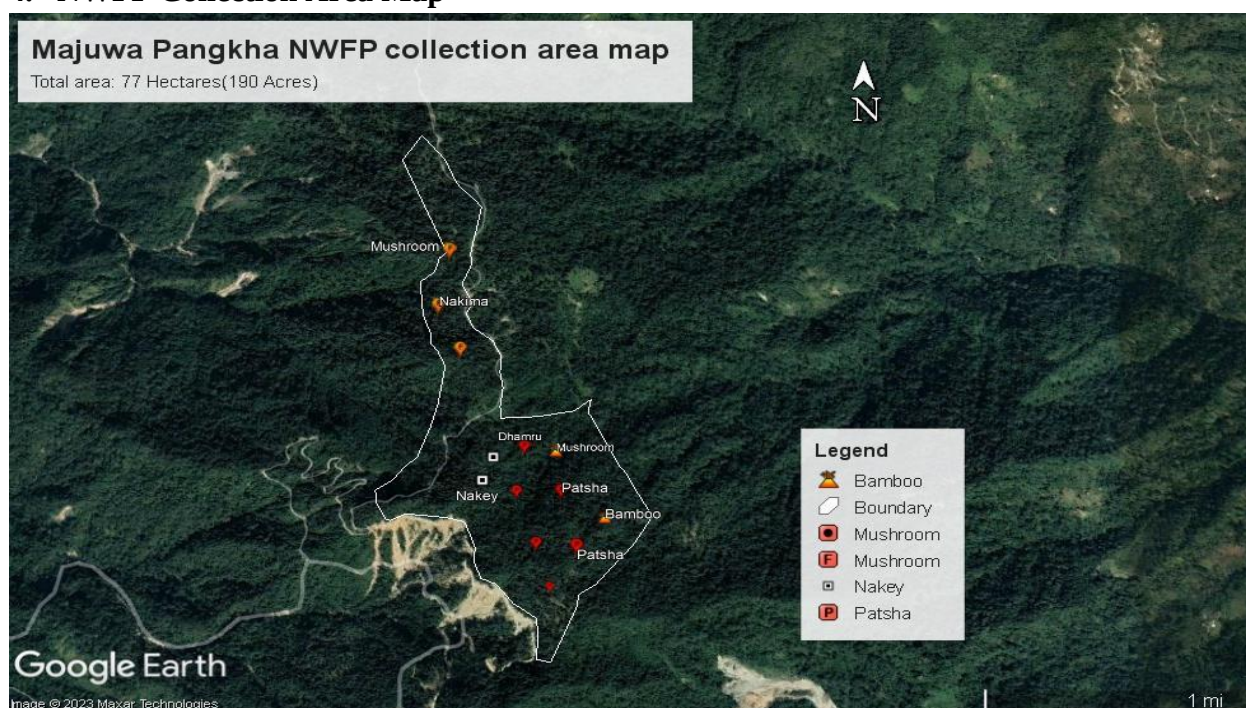


Figure 1. Map of NWFP collection sites.

5. Marketing arrangements

Each member will collect/harvest NWFP products as per the directives of the coordinator. The products will be sold to the local market. If products exceed the local demand, the executive members will trade to the National and International market. The coordinator will explore the market in collaboration with the respective field forestry offices and make linkages with exporters.

Table 2. Procedures for NWFP harvesting, marketing and sharing of income

Activity	Brief description on how the activities is carried out
Harvesting of products	Collection of above NWFPs will be done in group consisting of around 10 members depending upon their season.
Postharvest practices	Drying and packaging of the product will be done in group.
Marketing of products	The coordinator will market the NWFP on behalf of the group. No individual collection will be allowed for marketing, however the members can collect individually if it is for self-consumption.
Transportation	The expenses incurred for purchasing packing materials and transportation for marketing will be borne from the income generated by the group.
Identification of buyers	The products will be sold to the local market, national and international market.
Price fixing	The products will be sold at the market price or as per the expected price mentioned in the plan.
Raising of community development fund	The income generated will be deposited in the group fund after the deduction of expenses incurred.
Payment to committee members for their service	No payment shall be done to individual member for collection of NWFP, drying and packaging work as it will be considered as labour contribution for the group.

Table 3. Marketing and sales plan

NWFP	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale/season (unit)	Expected price per unit (Nu)	Total (Nu)
Patsha	Local Market and Samtse	250 pieces	30	7,500
Fern	Local Market and Samtse	500 bundles per season	10	5,000
Chirata	Local Market and Samtse	1 kg per season	3,000	3,000
Nikima	Local Market and Samtse	10 kg per season	50	500
Bamboo shoot (Balu Gopay)	Local Market and Samtse	10 kg per season	30	300
Mushroom	Local Market and Samtse	20 per kg	100	2,000
Other medicinal	Local and national market	1kg	1,500 (Lump-sum)	1,500
			Total	19,800

(other medicinal plants shall include Harchur, Buro Oakatey, Shikari Lahara)

6. Benefits to the members

- The members may avail loan from the group saving.
- The members shall have a free access of NWFPs for self-consumption.
- Any member can earn income through sale of NWFPs.
- All member has right to get equal share from the accumulated group fund.

7. Benefits to the group

- The fund from the group saving may be used for Community Developmental activities.
- The NWFPs can be managed in a sustainable manner.
- Protection of NWFPs from illicit harvesting and unsustainable harvesting
- Sustainable harvesting guidelines and management plan in place.
- Easy access to permit for NWFPs harvesting and marketing.

Part B: By-Laws: Group regulations and norms

The members of the Majuwa_Pangkha NWFP management plan shall be guided by a by-law whereby it shall consist of group regulations and norms that should be followed by the group members. The roles and responsibilities of each member are mentioned for successful implementation of the activities mentioned in this plan.

8. Members of the NWFP management and marketing groups

Table 4. Responsibilities and rights of members and details of NWFP group

Village	No. of member households	Gewog
Sengdhen	21	Dophuchen
Majuwa	14	
Pangkha	6	
Responsibilities and rights of members: a) To elect eminent executive committee b) To terminate executive committee if the performance is found unsatisfactory. c) To adhere the By-laws strictly d) To protect the listed resources from illegal collection by outsiders e) To plan, decide, and approve the plan/activities in the meeting. f) To implement the activities as directed by the executive committee. g) The members of the group shall allow the collection of NWFPs by non-members for self-consumption only upon obtaining permit.		

9. Roles and responsibilities of Executive Members

Table 5. Responsibilities of Chairperson, Secretary and Treasurer

Chairperson	Name of Chairperson: Dal Man Rai (17379733)
	Responsibilities of Coordinator/chairperson: ➤ To prepare an agenda, conduct and chair the meeting. ➤ To execute the planned activities, monitor and review the action plan. ➤ To enforce By-laws and resolve conflicts among members and outsiders. ➤ To entertain guests and visitors. ➤ To obtain collection permits during collection seasons ➤ Signatory authority for official correspondences and for accounts in collaboration with Accountant. ➤ To seek technical assistance and collect market information
Secretary	Name of Secretary: Gajurey (77408833)
	➤ To officiate chairman during his/her absence ➤ To keep minutes of the meetings ➤ To maintain records of official correspondence and attendance of labour contributions ➤ To disseminate the members about the meetings, working period and harvesting seasons ➤ To deal with offences and conflicts in mediation with the coordinator. ➤ To monitor the group during the working period.
Treasurer	Name of Treasurer: Ram Dhoj Rai (17948931)
	➤ To look after financial transition and maintain financial records. ➤ To collect membership fee and other funds and deposit in the bank. ➤ To sign the bank accounts jointly with Coordinator during financial transaction ➤ To present all the cash flows and financial transactions to the group during meeting

10. Membership arrangement

- a) **New member:** Membership fee collected till date and labour contribution will be assessed till date as per the prevailing local wage rate.
- b) **Membership withdrawal:** No benefits will be entertained. He/she will not be allowed to rejoin the NWFP, and the final decision lies within NWFP members. All pending bills/works need to be cleared prior to resignation from NWFP members.

Table 6. Membership Fee and purpose

Membership fee and Purpose	➤ Nu. 50 will be collected annually as Membership fee. ➤ The initial collection of membership fee will be deposited in the group account. ➤ The annual collection will be reserved as seed money and will be used for miscellaneous expenses before the initial sale of NWFPs
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11. Community development fund and utilization of fund

Table 7. Utilization of group fund and CDF

Community Development fund and utilization of fund	➤ The Joint Account will be opened in the name of Majuwa_Pangkha NWFP Collection and Management Group and the Coordinator and Accountant will be the Account bearers. ➤ Collection of NWFP will be done in group. ➤ Non-members shall be allowed collection of NWFPs for self-consumption only upon obtaining permit. ➤ The fund generated will be deposited in the Community fund. ➤ The Community fund will be used for loan to the members and other development activities for the group
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11.1. Loan

Disbursement of loans within members will depend on the accumulated group fund more than Nu. 30,000. Loan from NWFP fund shall not be eligible to non-members. Only one member from the household is eligible for loan at a time.

- Loan amount limit:** Nu. 20,000/-
- Interest rate:** 10% per annum
- Loan term:** Fixed for ONE year.
- Repayment:** Bi-annually
- Mortgage:** Borrower will have to surrender original *Thram* as the mortgage to NWFP group.

12. Conflict Resolution

- Any conflict arises about NWFPs and NWFP Collection and Management Group shall be mediated by the coordinator along with Executive members.
- The conflict prior to NWFP Group and outsiders shall be solved by the Chiwog Tshogpa.
- Any of the above conflicts which cannot be resolved at village level shall be forwarded to the Gewog and nearest forest office and finally to the Court.

13. Offences and Penalties

Table 8. Fines and penalties for settlement of offences

Offences	Fines and penalties	
	Member	Non-member
Late payment of membership fee and absentee fine	Nu. 5 per day	NA
Absent in meeting and work	Nu. 300/-	NA
Delaying of loan repayment	If the individual fails to repay the loan on stipulated time, he/she shall be liable for penalty i.e. Nu. 25/day for the late days only and he/she shall not be entertained with loan thereafter.	NA
Collection of NWFPs in the demarcated areas for sale	Should pay double the market value	As per market value and product will be released
Illegal felling of trees in the demarcated area	The offender shall be reported to the nearest Forest Office for legal action	
Misuse of group fund by executive members	Terminate from the respective post. The misused fund should be refunded along with 100% penalty	

14. Members of NWFP group

Table 4. Details of NWFP group members

SN	Name	CID No	House No & Tharm No	Contact No	Signature/Thump print
1	Badar Man Rai	11206003939	Da-06-785, 1631	77258804	
2	Dambar Singh Rai	11206003940	Da-06-785, 1631	77441380	
3	Dal Man Rai	11206003938	Da-06-784, 1603	17379733	
4	Pancha Bdr Rai	11206003946	Da-06-864, 1629	17748760	
5	Dhan Bdr Rai	11206003879	Da-06-nil/104, 232	17897126	
6	Indra Bdr Rai	11206007614	Da-06-460, 228	17624742	
7	Mani Raj Rai	11206005997	D-06-440, 1381	77263504	
8	Nar Bdr Rai	11206003894	Da-06-439, 3115	17263140	
9	Jas Man Rai	11206003853	Da-06-435, 227	17522315	
10	Birkha Dhan Rai	11206007613	Da-06-Nil/504, 1212	17465458	

11	Subha Dhan Rai	11206003961	Da-06-455, 1427	77419529	
12	Suraj Maya Rai	11205000463	Da-05-95, 119	17313929	
13	Jir Man Rai	11206003945	Da-06-448, 1630	77317406	
14	Som Raj Rai	11206003876	Da-06-438, 1344	16912484	
15	Prakash Rai	11206003856	Da-06-435, 227	77293559	
16	Ram Dhoj Rai	11206003854	Da-06-435, 227	17948931	
17	Deo Man Rai	11206007886	Da-06-460, 228	77237015	
18	Bak Man Rai	11206007888	Da-06-460, 228	17548245	
19	Mohan Singh Rai	11206004000	Da-06-453, 2557	17698039	
20	Moni Raj Rai	11206004091	Da-06-503, 229	17664796	
21	Dhan Maya Rai	11206003870	Da-06-Nil/369, 1441	17304796	
22	Mani Lal Rai	11206003953	Da-06-449, 2589	17305038	
23	Jit Maya Rai	11206003920	Da-06-443, 1503	77397281	
24	Rash Lachi Rai	11206003902	Da-06-445, 1431	77315698	
25	Bisnu Lachi Rai	11206004025	Da-06-877, 1209	17524665	
26	Mek Dhan Rai	11206007630	Da-06-902, 1210	17525228	
27	Harka Raj Rai	11206004023	Da-06-456, 237	17556280	
28	Maha Bir Rai	11206003955	Da-06-449, 2589	17525228	
29	Ajay Kumar Rai	11206003957	Da-06-nil/217, 2589	17920506	
30	Karney Rai	11206004089	Da-06-605, 1334	17686677	
31	Sabi Raj Rai	11206003905	Da-06-441, 1329	17641562	
32	Sovit Rai	11206004004	Da-06-453, 2559	17587951	
33	Ash Bdr Rai	11206004014	Da-06-454, 1806	17368988	
34	Gajuray Rai	11206003849	Da-06-435, 227	17963234	
35	Moni Kumar Rai	11206003878	Da-06-863, 1342	17850329	
36	Jok Bdr Rai	11206003909	Da-06-442, 228	17555737	
37	Raj Man Rai	11206007879	Da-06-460, 228	77396959	
38	Bika Raj Rai	11206004989	Da-06-472, 1071	17262617	
39	Boli Raj Rai	11206004053	Da-06-458, 1805	17916609	
40	Somitha Rai	11206003942	Da-06-447, 235	77664325	
41	Dhan Bdr Rai	11215003526	Da-06-449, 2589	17878647	